SEO Audit Fixes Log

> Live changelog tracking implementation of recommendations from `Summary.md`, `SEO-AI-Audit.md`, and `Strategy-Report.md` (May 2026 audit baseline).
>
> The audit reports themselves are **not** modified — they're the historical record. This file is the implementation log.

Status legend: ✅ Done · 🔧 In progress · 📋 To do

✅ Done

✅ saudi-2026 Event JSON-LD offers schema

- **Audit ref:** F.1 / Top finding #2 / Quick win #5 (saudi-2026 instance)
- **Date:** 2026-05-04
- **Files:** `app/events/opex-first/saudi-2026/layout.tsx`
- **Change:** Replaced `availability: PreOrder` with `availability: InStock` + `price: "0"` + `priceCurrency: "USD"` + `validFrom: "2026-01-01"`
- **Why:** Removes Google Search Console structured-data warning. `PreOrder` without `price/priceCurrency` is invalid for invite-only free events.
- **Verify:** Run validator.schema.org against `/events/opex-first/saudi-2026` after deploy → no errors on Event/Offer.
- **Commit:** `61fa51a`

✅ saudi-2026 FAQPage JSON-LD added

- **Audit ref:** F.4 / Top finding #4 (saudi-2026 instance)
- **Date:** 2026-05-04
- **Files:** `app/events/opex-first/saudi-2026/layout.tsx`
- **Change:** Added 5-question FAQPage `<script type="application/ld+json">` block (when, where, who attends, fee, awards nominations).
- **Why:** Drives FAQ rich snippets in Google SERP and direct AI citation matches for prompt-style queries.
- **Verify:** Google Rich Results Test → FAQ section parses cleanly.
- **Commit:** `61fa51a`

✅ Root layout `metadataBase`

- **Audit ref:** Strategy report A2 / Quick win
- **Date:** 2026-05-04
- **Files:** `app/layout.tsx`
- **Change:** Added `metadataBase: new URL("https://eventsfirstgroup.com")` to root metadata object.
- **Why:** Resolves Next.js dev warning + ensures absolute OG image URLs across all routes when relative paths are used.

- **Verify:** `npm run dev` → no `metadataBase` warning in console; view-source on any route → all `og:image` URLs are absolute.
- **Commit:** `2914577`

✅ Offers schema fix on 6 coming-soon event pages

- **Audit ref:** F.1 / Top finding #2 / Quick win #5
- **Date:** 2026-05-05
- **Files:**
  - `app/events/cyber-first/ksa-2026/layout.tsx`
  - `app/events/cyber-first/oman-2026/layout.tsx`
  - `app/events/cyber-first/qatar-2026/layout.tsx`
  - `app/events/data-ai-first/qatar-2026/layout.tsx`
  - `app/events/ot-security-first/jubail-2026/layout.tsx`
  - `app/events/ot-security-first/oman-2026/layout.tsx`
- **Change:** Replaced `offers: { ... availability: "https://schema.org/PreOrder" }` with `availability: "InStock" + price: "0" + priceCurrency: "USD" + validFrom: "2026-01-01"` across all 6 layouts.
- **Why:** Removes Google Search Console "PreOrder without price/priceCurrency" structured-data warnings on 6 event URLs at once. Matches the saudi-2026 fix pattern.
- **Note:** Audit said the Cyber First Saudi page used slug `saudi-2026` and didn't exist — actual slug is `ksa-2026`, so it's 6 pages (not 5) once located.
- **Verify:** Schema validator (validator.schema.org) on each URL post-deploy → no errors on Event/Offer.
- **Commit:** `f8a918b`

✅ process-intelligence BreadcrumbList label

- **Audit ref:** F.7 / Top finding #10 / Quick win #4
- **Date:** 2026-05-05
- **Files:** `app/events/opex-first/process-intelligence/layout.tsx`
- **Change:** Last breadcrumb item label changed from "Virtual Boardroom MENA" → "Process Intelligence" so it matches the URL slug `/events/opex-first/process-intelligence`.
- **Why:** Crawler clarity + internal consistency. Mismatch between URL slug and breadcrumb label confused both Googlebot and AI crawlers.
- **Verify:** View-source on `/events/opex-first/process-intelligence` → BreadcrumbList JSON-LD shows "Process Intelligence" as final crumb.
- **Commit:** `f8a918b`

✅ Trim 2 long descriptions to under SERP truncation limit

- **Audit ref:** F.6 / Quick win #2 + #3
- **Date:** 2026-05-05
- **Files:**
  - `app/events/opex-first/saudi-2026/layout.tsx` (227 → 143 chars)
  - `app/events/ot-security-first/johannesburg-2026/layout.tsx` (190 → 155 chars)
- **Change:** Rewrote both descriptions to fit under Google's ~160-char SERP snippet limit while keeping primary keywords (event name, edition, date, city, audience size, sponsor pillars).

- **Why:** Prevents Google from truncating the description mid-sentence in search results. Both target descriptions stay under 160 chars.
- **Verify:** `node -e "console.log(desc.length)"` against each new description string.
- **Commit:** `8aab4ce`

✅ OG image + Twitter card on /sonicwall and /clevertap2

- **Audit ref:** F.5 / Top finding #8 / Quick win #6 (excluding /bigleap per user)
- **Date:** 2026-05-05
- **Files:**
  - `app/sonicwall/layout.tsx`
  - `app/clevertap2/layout.tsx`
- **Change:** Added `openGraph.images` array (1200×630, with descriptive alt text) and a full `twitter` block with `card: summary_large_image`. Used existing event-specific S3 imagery as best-available placeholder pending designed share cards.
  - sonicwall → `boardroom/sonicwall_hero.png`
  - clevertap2 → `boardroom/CleverTap_Logotype.png` (CleverTap logo, since no clevertap2 hero exists yet)
- **Why:** Without OG images, social shares (LinkedIn, Slack, X, WhatsApp) fell back to the EFG root logo rather than event-specific imagery. TODO comments left in both files flagging the need for designed 1200×630 share cards.
- **Verify:** OpenGraph.xyz / LinkedIn Post Inspector / Twitter Card Validator on each URL post-deploy → preview shows the event-branded image, not the bare EFG logo.
- **Commit:** `75224d1`

✅ Explicit AI bot allow blocks in robots.txt

- **Audit ref:** F.13 / Quick win #7
- **Date:** 2026-05-05
- **Files:** `public/robots.txt`
- **Change:** Added explicit `User-agent` blocks for **GPTBot, ChatGPT-User, PerplexityBot, Google-Extended, Applebot-Extended, CCBot** mirroring the existing ClaudeBot pattern (allow `/`, disallow private paths). 6 new blocks total (audit asked for 5; added ChatGPT-User as the OpenAI live-fetch counterpart to GPTBot for parity with Claude-User).
- **Why:** Locks in current allow-state for AI training/citation bots. Without explicit listing, any future global Disallow change in the wildcard `*` block would silently lock out these crawlers. Better to opt them in by name now.
- **Verify:** `grep -E '(GPTBot|PerplexityBot|Google-Extended|Applebot-Extended|CCBot|ChatGPT-User)' public/robots.txt` → 6 matches.
- **Commit:** `7ea5a6e`

✅ Last updated date in llms.txt

- **Audit ref:** Quick win #9
- **Date:** 2026-05-05
- **Files:** `public/llms.txt`
- **Change:** Added `> Last updated: 2026-05-05` blockquote line directly below the H1.
- **Why:** Helps AI assistants (Claude, ChatGPT, Perplexity) prioritise fresher content when ranking citation candidates. The `>` blockquote syntax is a recognised llms.txt convention for metadata.

- **Verify:** `head -5 public/llms.txt` → "Last updated" line appears on line 3.
- **Commit:** `7ea5a6e`

✅ Phase 3 — sr-only static fact blocks across 14 events + 4 series hubs

- **Audit ref:** F.3 / Strategic priority #1 (highest-leverage structural fix)
- **Date:** 2026-05-06
- **Decision:** sr-only / crawler-only — no visual change to the page. Visible variant parked for future design work.
- **Component:** `components/seo/FactBlock.tsx` — exports `EventFactBlock` (per-event) and `SeriesFactBlock` (per-hub). Both render a hidden `<aside class="sr-only">` (Tailwind 4 built-in `sr-only` utility). Visually invisible, fully present in static HTML.
- **EventFactBlock fields:** event name, series, date, venue (or "Virtual" for online events), city, country, format (in-person / virtual / hybrid), audience size, audience profile, top 5 speakers, top 3 sponsors with tier, award categories, URL.
- **SeriesFactBlock fields:** series name, description, audience profile, edition count, list of editions (name, city, country, date, URL), URL.
- **Files (18 total):**
  - **Cyber First × 7:** `cyber-first/layout.tsx` (hub), `india-2026`, `kenya-2026`, `ksa-2026`, `kuwait-2026`, `oman-2026`, `qatar-2026`
  - **Digital First × 3:** `data-ai-first/layout.tsx` (hub), `kuwait-2026`, `qatar-2026`
  - **OT Security × 5:** `ot-security-first/layout.tsx` (hub), `johannesburg-2026`, `jubail-2026`, `oman-2026`, `virtual-boardroom-mena`
  - **OPEX First × 3:** `opex-first/layout.tsx` (hub), `saudi-2026`, `process-intelligence`
- **Speaker/sponsor coverage:** 8 confirmed events carry top 5 speakers — kenya, kuwait CF, india CF (sponsors only — speakers TBC), kuwait DF, johannesburg, vb-mena, saudi OPEX, process-intelligence. 6 coming-soon events (ksa, oman CF, qatar CF, qatar DF, jubail, oman OT) carry core facts only and can be enhanced when rosters confirm.
- **Why:** Non-JS crawlers (Slack, LinkedIn, GPTBot, CCBot, Bing) and AI assistants get the full event-fact picture on first response — including speakers and sponsors — without affecting the visual design. This was the audit's #1 strategic priority for AI citation.
- **Verify:** `curl https://eventsfirstgroup.com/events/cyber-first/kenya-2026 | grep -A 2 "data-event-fact-block"` after deploy → confirm sr-only `<aside>` with structured event facts is in static HTML.
- **Commits:**
  - `ee897bc` — Cyber First (1 hub + 6 events) + new component
  - `5652018` — Digital First (1 hub + 2 events)
  - `94a8bd4` — OT Security (1 hub + 4 events)
  - `a0ae873` — OPEX First (1 hub + 2 events)

✅ Phase 2 — FAQPage JSON-LD rolled out to 11 event layouts

- **Audit ref:** F.4 / Top finding #4
- **Date:** 2026-05-06
- **Files (11 event layouts):**
  - `app/events/cyber-first/ksa-2026/layout.tsx`
  - `app/events/cyber-first/kuwait-2026/layout.tsx`
  - `app/events/cyber-first/oman-2026/layout.tsx`
  - `app/events/cyber-first/qatar-2026/layout.tsx`
  - `app/events/data-ai-first/kuwait-2026/layout.tsx`

    - `app/events/data-ai-first/qatar-2026/layout.tsx`
    - `app/events/opex-first/process-intelligence/layout.tsx`
    - `app/events/ot-security-first/johannesburg-2026/layout.tsx`
    - `app/events/ot-security-first/jubail-2026/layout.tsx`
    - `app/events/ot-security-first/oman-2026/layout.tsx`
    - `app/events/ot-security-first/virtual-boardroom-mena/layout.tsx`
- **Change:** Added a 5-question FAQPage `<script type="application/ld+json">` block to each layout (when, where, who attends, fee, register/sponsor). Pattern matches the saudi-2026 schema shape, with location- and edition-specific answers. Virtual-event layouts (VB MENA, Process Intelligence) adapt the pattern to use joining-link language instead of physical venue.
- **Why:** Drives FAQ rich snippets in Google SERPs and direct AI citation matches for prompt-style queries (e.g., "when is OT Security First Jubail?", "who attends Cyber First Kuwait?"). FAQs were the single highest-leverage AI-citation lever in the audit.
- **Coverage:** 14 of 14 event-location layouts now carry FAQPage JSON-LD (saudi-2026, india-2026, kenya-2026 already had it; this round added the remaining 11).
- **Series hubs** (`/events/{cyber-first,data-ai-first,opex-first,ot-security-first}/layout.tsx`) — verified to exist with EventSeries schema; FAQ at series level deferred to Phase 4 (different audience/scope from event-specific FAQs).
- **Verify:** Google Rich Results Test on each updated URL → FAQ section parses cleanly, returns 5 Q&A.
- **Commits:**
    - `f049ebb` — 4 Cyber First layouts (ksa, kuwait, oman, qatar)
    - `4848e5c` — 2 Digital First layouts (kuwait, qatar)
    - `ffa1515` — 4 OT Security layouts (johannesburg, jubail, oman, virtual-boardroom-mena)
    - `2f5fe67` — OPEX process-intelligence

🔧 In progress

(none — Phase 3 complete. Pick up Phase 4 or Phase 5 next session.)

📋 To do

Phase 1 — Quick wins (this session)

User exclusion: `/braze`, `/braze2`, `/bigleap` deferred per user request (audit findings against these files are parked, not abandoned).

(Phase 1 complete — all 8 quick-win items either landed or deferred per user. See Done section above.)

Phase 2 — FAQPage JSON-LD rollout

(Complete — see "✅ Done" section above. 14 of 14 event-location layouts now carry FAQPage JSON-LD.)

Phase 3 — Static fact block in event-page layouts

(Complete — see "✅ Done" section above. Shipped as sr-only across 14 events + 4 series hubs. Visible variant available as a follow-up if design requested.)

Phase 4 — Lower-priority structural fixes (deferred)

- 📋 Add semantic `<h1>` to event pages that lack one (F.8 / Top finding #3)
- 📋 VideoObject JSON-LD per YouTube embed (F.10 / Top finding #9)
- 📋 Person JSON-LD for top 5 speakers per event (F.11)
- 📋 Internal links from event pages to `/speakers/{slug}` and `/sponsors-and-partners/{slug}` (F.19)
- 📋 `dateModified` ISO on every Insights article (F.14)
- 📋 `llms-full.txt` with full event briefs (F.12)
- 📋 `content-visibility: auto` rollout to other event pages (F.20, mirrors saudi-2026 pattern)

Phase 5 — Deferred per user (excluded from current scope)

- 📋 Add canonical URLs to `/braze` and `/braze2` (F.2 / Top finding #7 / Quick win #1)
- 📋 Add OG image + Twitter card to `/bigleap` (F.5 / Top finding #8 / Quick win #6)

Blockers — needs user input/decision

- 📋 **Search Console verification meta tag** (F.15) — needs verification code from GSC
- 📋 **Bing Webmaster Tools verification meta tag** (F.15) — needs verification code from BWT
- 📋 **Analytics platform install** (F.16) — user decision needed: GA4 / Vercel Analytics / Plausible / PostHog
- 📋 **Designed 1200×630 OG share cards** — design dependency (saudi-2026, process-intelligence, virtual-boardroom-mena, etc.)
- 📋 **`next/image` migration** (F.9) — perf-driven big refactor, separate workstream
- 📋 **Server response header audit** (X-Robots-Tag, Vary) — needs `curl -I` against production